



To The Rescue

Use Norton Ghost to keep your data safe from untoward incidents

Samir Makwana

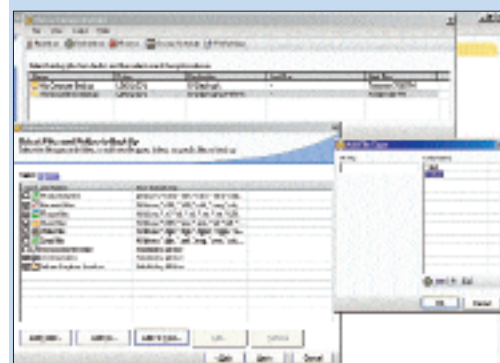
Norton Ghost may cost a bit, but it's a brilliant solution to take backups and images of your data. You can find the trial version on this month's DVD.



A good backup strategy is always important

The Basics

When you run the program for the first time, you'll be asked to select a backup destination. Choose any healthy drive or partition except for C:, or



Specify critical files and folders for backing up

better yet, an external hard disk. After setting the backup destination, define the source—choose Run or Manage Backups under the Tasks menu or the main screen. Ghost lets you back up selected files and folders, or entire drives. Drive backups are called Recovery Points, and are saved with the .v2i, .iv2i or .pqi extensions. The new version of Ghost lets you create drive images as well as file and folder backups (the older versions were only drive imaging utilities), so it's a complete backup solution.

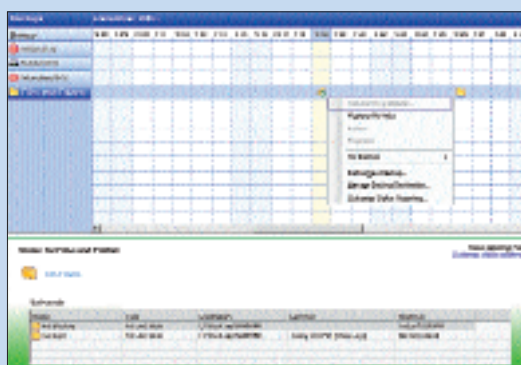
To define a backup, open the Tasks tab in Ghost and choose Run or Manage Backups. To back up everything on your computer, select Back Up My Computer. The Back Up My Documents option will allow back up your My Documents folder, in addition to file types like music, movies and so on. To change the drives you want to back up (or files in the latter case), click on the drive letter (or folder name) in the dialog.

The recovery points you create can be copied to CD/DVD under Tools > Copy Recovery Point.

Browsing A Recovery Point

Once you've made a recovery point of a partition or on your hard drive, you can browse through the files as they were at the time of the backup, and even restore individual files instead of restoring the entire recovery point. Go to Tools > Recovery Point Browser and open the Recovery Point you want to browse through. To restore an old version of a file, right-click on it and choose Recover.

You can also browse the recovery point in Windows Explorer by mounting it as a separate drive. In the Recovery Point Browser, select the Recovery Point and click Mount. Alternatively, you can use Windows Explorer to browse to the Recovery Point, right-click on it and choose Mount. You'll be



Timely backups can bring about peace of mind!

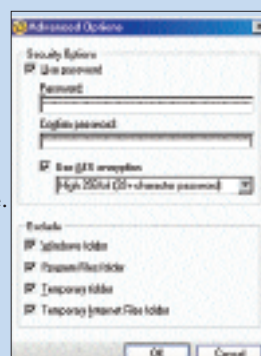
asked to give it a drive letter, and you'll be able to browse through it like you would any other partition on your PC. Any changes you make to the mounted image will go away once you un-mount the recovery point.

Unattended Backups And Restores

You can schedule incremental backups under the Status menu by editing the calendar. Right-click on the calendar and choose Define New Backup. To backup computers on the network, go to Computers > Add and add the IP address of the computer you want to back up. Once it's connected, you can create recovery points, schedule, and even restore backups on the computers in the list.

Helpful Tools

Backups can be taxing on your system; you can set a default performance level for backups in Tasks > Options > Performance. You can also set security options while setting up a backup under the Advanced tab. You'll get different encryption options to password-protect (the character limit depends on the encryption level) the backup files.



Backups stay secured by setting password-protected encryption

Pay!

When you pay and obtain the full version of Ghost, you get the ability to convert recovery points to VMware virtual disks, and the ability to copy one hard disk to another. Existing recovery points can be converted to the VMware virtual disk format for use as a virtual OS. Go to Tools > Convert to Virtual Disk. To make a copy of your hard drive, go to Tools > Copy My Hard Drive.

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To set up filters, go to Settings > Filters and click on Create a New Filter. Enter information for the necessary criteria along with wildcards. For example, if you want all your mails from Orkut to be labelled, enter orkut in the subject field. Go to the next step. Check the box against Apply a Label and select a label from the list. Set any other options that you want and click Create Filter.

Connecting To AIM Through Gmail

You can now login to your AIM or ICQ user ID using Gmail. When you've logged into Gmail, click on Options in the Chat and click Sign into AIM. Enter your username and password and click on Sign in. You will be logged in, and all your AIM contacts will be displayed along with your Google Talk buddies with an AIM logo on the side.

IMAP For Free!

Gmail has had POP3 for a while now and now they're taking it one step further—you can now get IMAP too! IMAP synchronises mail between the Gmail server and your local machine or devices. So now, you can have the same mails on your Gmail account on the Internet, your desktop computer, your phone and so on, as long as the mail client supports IMAP. Anything that you do to your mail from any device will be updated on the server. So if you move a file from one folder to the other using your phone, that change will be reflected on Gmail and your mail client at home.

First, enable IMAP for our account—once you're logged into your Gmail account, go to Settings > Forwarding and POP / IMAP. Under the header IMAP Access, click Enable IMAP and click Save Changes. Next, set up IMAP for the mail client. We'll use Outlook Express since it's available on every Windows machine. You can use similar steps for any other IMAP-supporting mail client that you may use. Create a new IMAP account by going to Tools > Accounts and select Add > Mail. Enter a display name and your Gmail address. Keep clicking Next till you reach the Window where you need to enter the server addresses. Select the server type as IMAP from the drop-down. Enter the address for incoming mail server as imap.gmail.com and outgoing as smtp.gmail.com. Click Next. Enter your account name as your_mail_id@gmail.com. Enter your password and proceed to finish the setup. Click on Properties for the account you just created. Go to the Advanced tab and enter the Outgoing

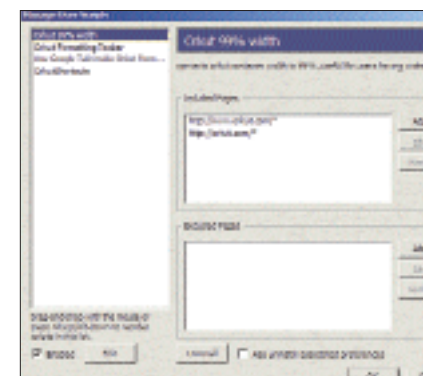
SMTP port number as 465 and incoming as 993. Also check the boxes against This server requires a secure connection (SSL) for both the incoming and outgoing ports. Before clicking OK, go to the Servers tab and check the box against My server requires authentication for the Outgoing Mail server. Click OK and click the Send / Receive button. All the folders on your Gmail server will be downloaded and you can start using your IMAP enabled Gmail account.

ORKUT

We'll be honest here—we're not the biggest Orkut fans, but you can't ignore it. With a Firefox add-on called Greasemonkey, you can enhance your Orkut-ing experience quite a bit.

Scripts for Firefox

Other than the general JavaScript tricks that work on any browser, there are some that work on Greasemonkey. Greasemonkey is an add-on for Firefox that allows you to run scripts that can modify the characteristics of a page.



Greasemonkey can be used to add and modify features in a page

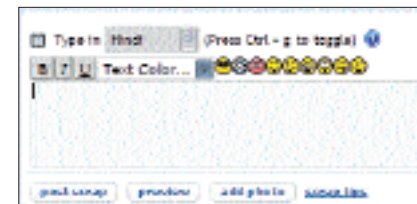
You can get information on Greasemonkey from www.greasespot.net. Download Greasemonkey from there. Once you've installed the add-on, restart Firefox.

Widescreen Orkut-ing

Widescreen LCDs are great for gaming and for watching movies. It turns out Orkut on widescreen is pretty useful as well.

There's a Greasemonkey script which stretches Orkut pages so you see a lot more and have far less vertical scrolling to do.

When you have Greasemonkey setup right, visit <http://userscripts.org/scripts/source/12286.user.js>. A window should pop up to confirm the adding of the script. Click Install. Orkut pages will now be stretched to the width of the window.



The lack of visible formatting tools can be fixed by using a Greasemonkey script

Add A Formatting Bar

When it's time to scrap your buddy back and you want to keep things a little colourful, you're busy looking for the formatting tools like in any other forum. Orkut's formatting tools can be accessed by clicking the scrap tips link next to the text entry box. There's also a Greasemonkey script that will make the formatting tools show up right on top of the text box. Download it from <http://userscripts.org/scripts/source/12841.user.js>.

Adding a Talk gadget in Orkut

We've shown you how to use Google Talk in your browser before, but now you can go crazy chatting with your buddies through Orkut itself. Download this script: <http://userscripts.org/scripts/source/12532.user.js>. Go back to your Orkut home page and you'll see a Google Talk add-on above your friends list. Click Show GTalk to show the application.

Keyboard Shortcuts For Orkut

With the power of Greasemonkey and its scripts, you can now use shortcuts to quickly jump from your scrapbook to your home page, for example. Download the script from <http://userscripts.org/scripts/source/12784.user.js> and then use the shortcuts given below.

Home: [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [H]
Scrapbook: [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [S]
Friends list: [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F]
Communities: [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [C]

Hiding Your Content

Google's stepped up their effort to make Orkut a little more private by



Privacy has been implemented in Orkut